

The great conqueror

After *years in the wilderness*, Genghis took back his father's tribe and united the Mongol tribes. By 1204, Genghis was **SUPREME KHAN** of all the Mongols, and was ready for war. Within five years, his army had taken parts of China. They then took Siberia, Afghanistan, and parts of the Persian Empire. Cities were so **afraid of the Khan** that they often surrendered before he even arrived.



Mongols lived in "gers" (meaning "home"), which were circular wooden frames covered with felt.

War on the move

Every Mongol warrior usually owned three or four horses, which they kept roped together. By frequently changing horses, the army could cover **huge distances very quickly**. The Mongols were **NOMADIC**, so they were used to traveling around. At the end of the day they would build camp and practice their battle skills by *hunting for their dinner*.

A mighty empire
Genghis created the world's longest lasting empire. He encouraged religious tolerance, introduced new laws, and brought a new writing system to the illiterate Mongol people. Unfortunately, up to 40 million people might have died as a result of his conquests.

He paved the way for...

Genghis's grandson **KUBLAI KHAN** (1215–1294) established the Yuan Dynasty and became **EMPEROR OF CHINA**.



DNA STUDIES have shown that as many as **16 MILLION MEN** worldwide are descended from Genghis Khan.

